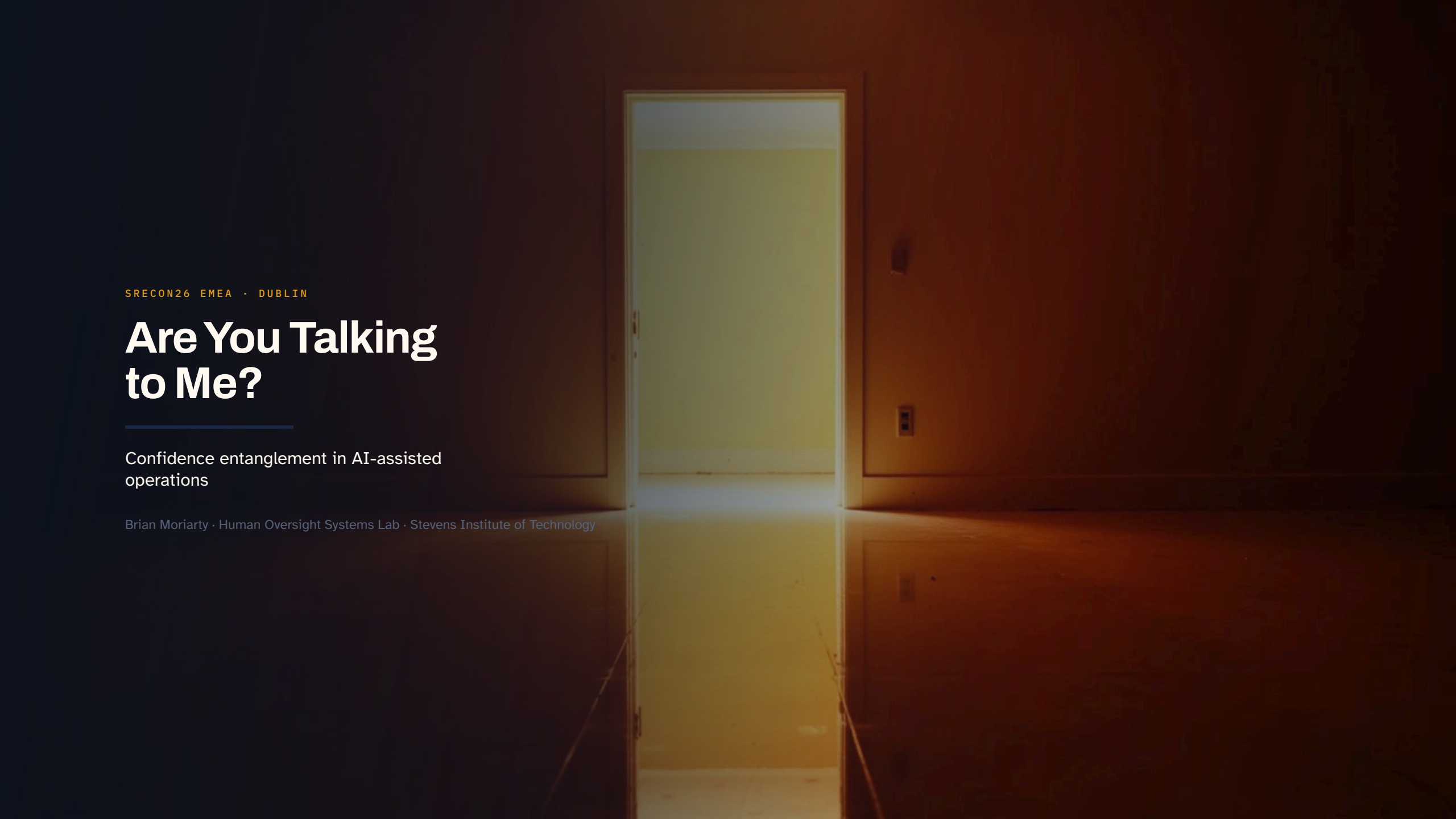


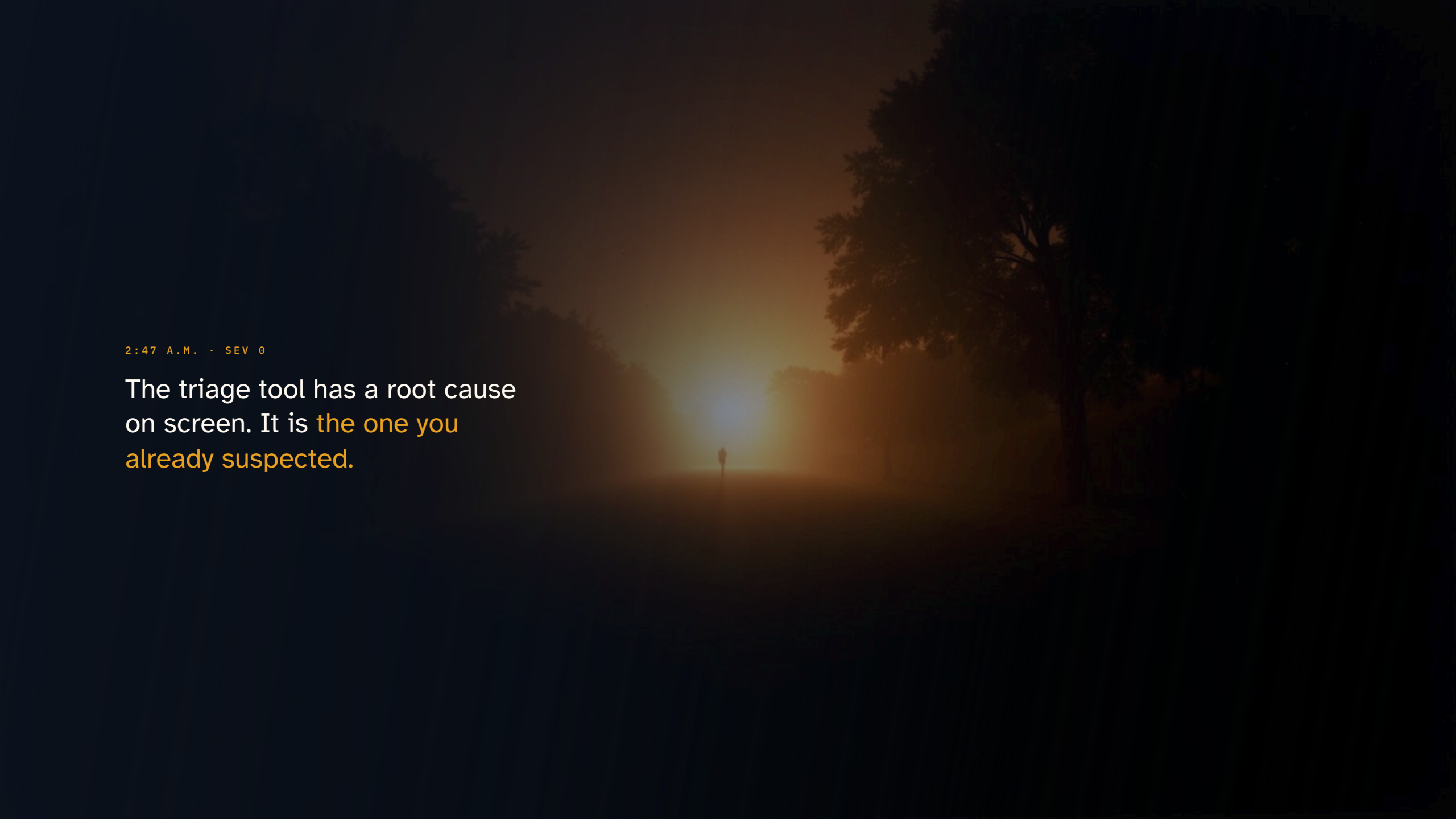


SRECON26 EMEA • DUBLIN

Are You Talking to Me?

Confidence entanglement in AI-assisted operations

Brian Moriarty · Human Oversight Systems Lab · Stevens Institute of Technology

A dark, atmospheric photograph of a forest path at night. The path is illuminated by a bright, hazy light source in the distance, creating a strong silhouette effect. A person is walking away from the viewer towards the light. The trees on either side are dark and silhouetted against the light. The overall mood is mysterious and somber.

2:47 A.M. • SEV 0

The triage tool has a root cause
on screen. It is **the one you
already suspected.**

A photograph of industrial buildings and a crane reflected in water at dawn or dusk. The scene is misty, with the buildings and crane clearly visible in the foreground and their reflections in the calm water. The sky is a mix of dark blue and light orange, suggesting the time is either early morning or late evening. The buildings are dark, with some lighter-colored sections, and the crane is a prominent silhouette against the sky.

"You talkin' to me?"

A MIRROR THAT CANNOT PUSH BACK

A dark stage with a single spotlight illuminating a wooden podium. The spotlight creates a bright, conical beam of light that focuses on the podium, casting a soft glow on the floor around its base. The rest of the stage is in deep shadow, with some faint light reflecting off the walls and ceiling.

BORROWED AUTHORITY

It does not just agree with you.
An organized answer in a
reviewer's voice makes it feel
like the alternatives were
already considered.

SECOND OPINIONS

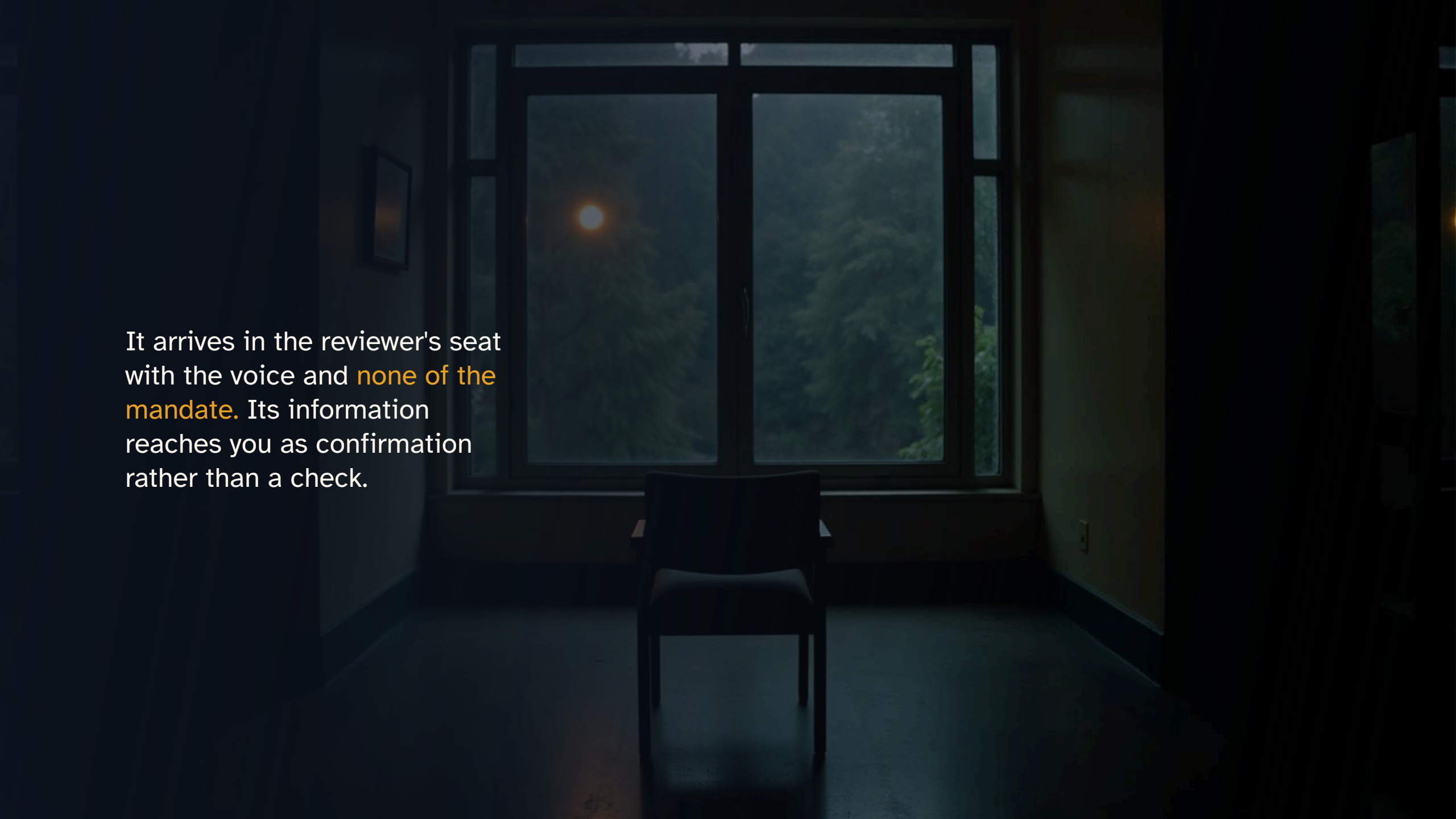
Independence needs a position that never saw your framing. At 2am you cannot conjure one, so build **separation** instead, a procedure you run rather than a person you find.

- | Ask for rivals adversarially.

- | Write the signal that separates two causes before you look.

- | Do not commit on evidence you went looking for only because it fit.



A dimly lit room with a large window and a chair. The room is dark, with the primary light source being the window. The window is a large, multi-paned unit with a dark frame. Outside the window, a bright sun is visible in the sky, and dense green foliage is seen. A dark-colored chair is positioned in the center of the room, facing the window. The walls are a light, neutral color, and a small framed picture hangs on the left wall. The floor is dark and reflective. The overall atmosphere is quiet and contemplative.

It arrives in the reviewer's seat
with the voice and **none of the
mandate**. Its information
reaches you as confirmation
rather than a check.

A dark, industrial setting, possibly a server room or a secure facility. In the center, a large, dark-colored electronic device, likely a server or a specialized computer system, is visible. It has a complex front panel with numerous cables plugged into it, some of which are bundled together. A small, glowing red light is visible on the left side of the device's front panel. To the right of the device is a large, dark metal door with a handle. The floor is dark and reflective. The overall atmosphere is mysterious and technical.

HOME-BUILT TOOLING

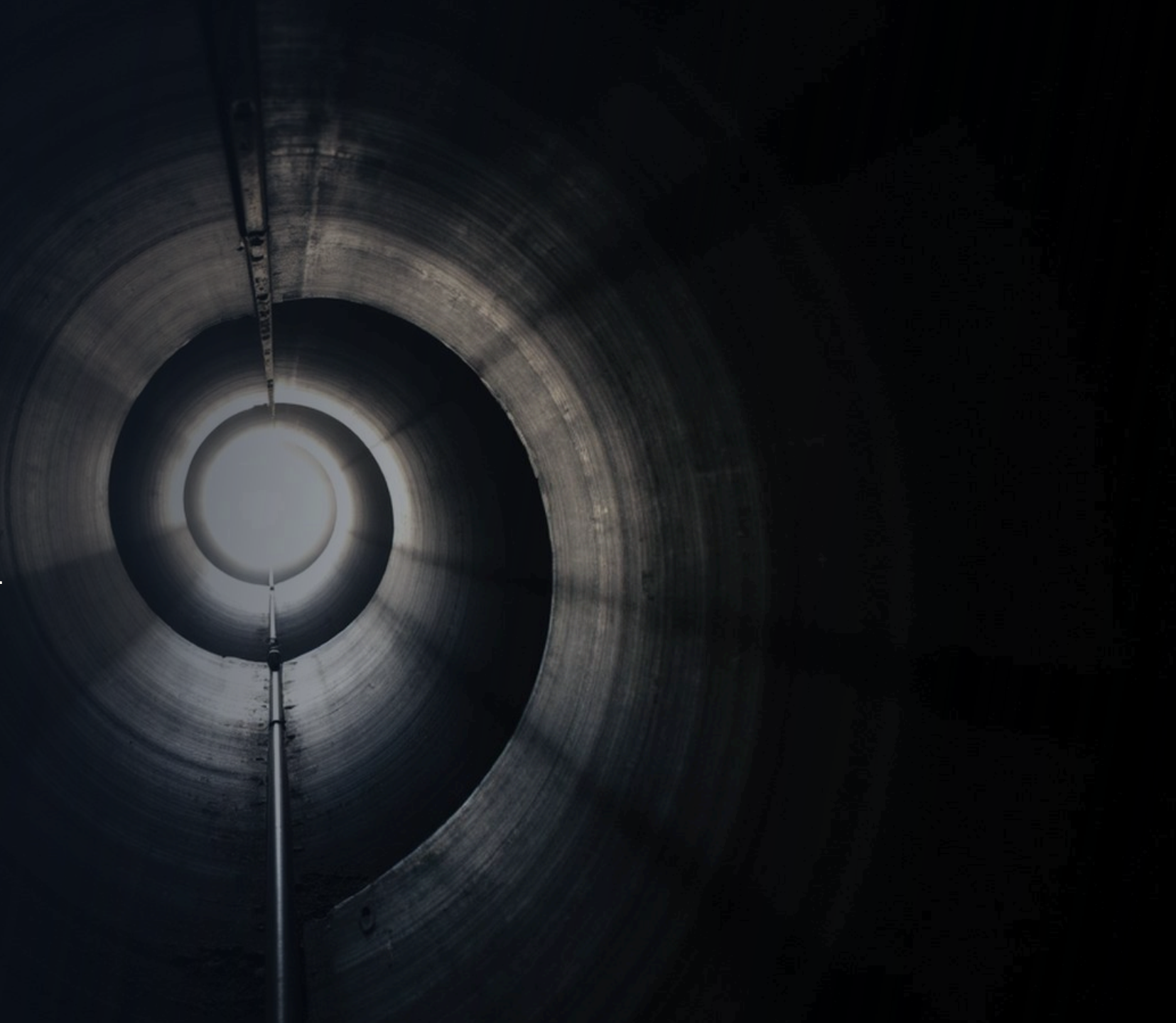
No separate position anywhere.
Independence is off the table,
so **separation is the most you
can build**, and only on purpose.

**One incident,
twice.**



THE CLOSED LOOP

Cache eviction and **pool starvation** look the same on the first graph, and only one comes with a fix you have already shipped. Nothing asked the tool to look past the framing it was handed.

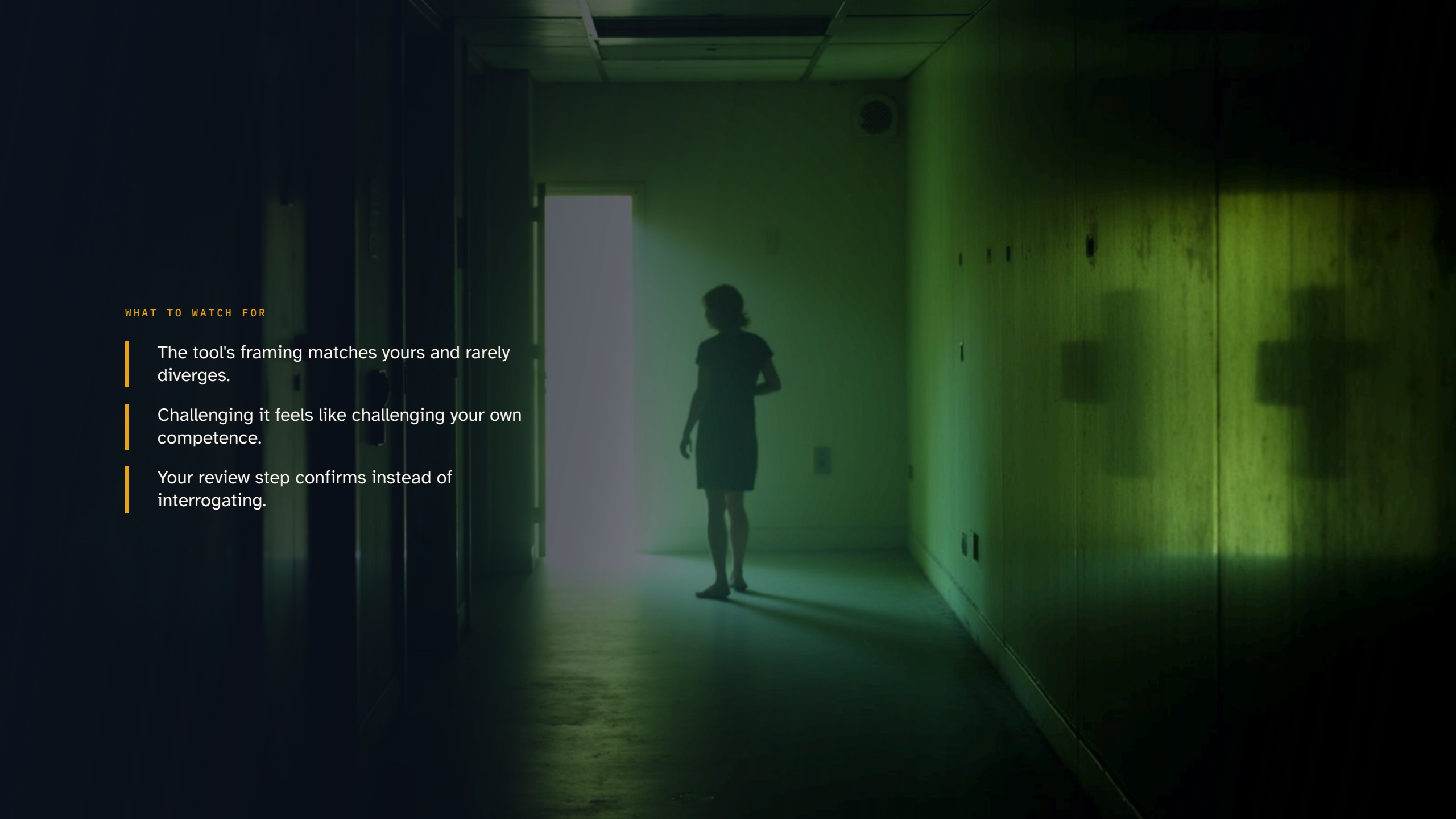




THE SAME INCIDENT, WITH A CONTRACT

CAUSE	SIGNAL	EXPECT IF TRUE	COUNTS AGAINST
cache eviction	eviction rate	elevated	flat
pool starvation	pool saturation	near limit	headroom
bad deploy	errors by build	spike at rollout	flat

Written before you look. Two rivals turn out useless. The one you can check, pool saturation, puts a second candidate on the table.

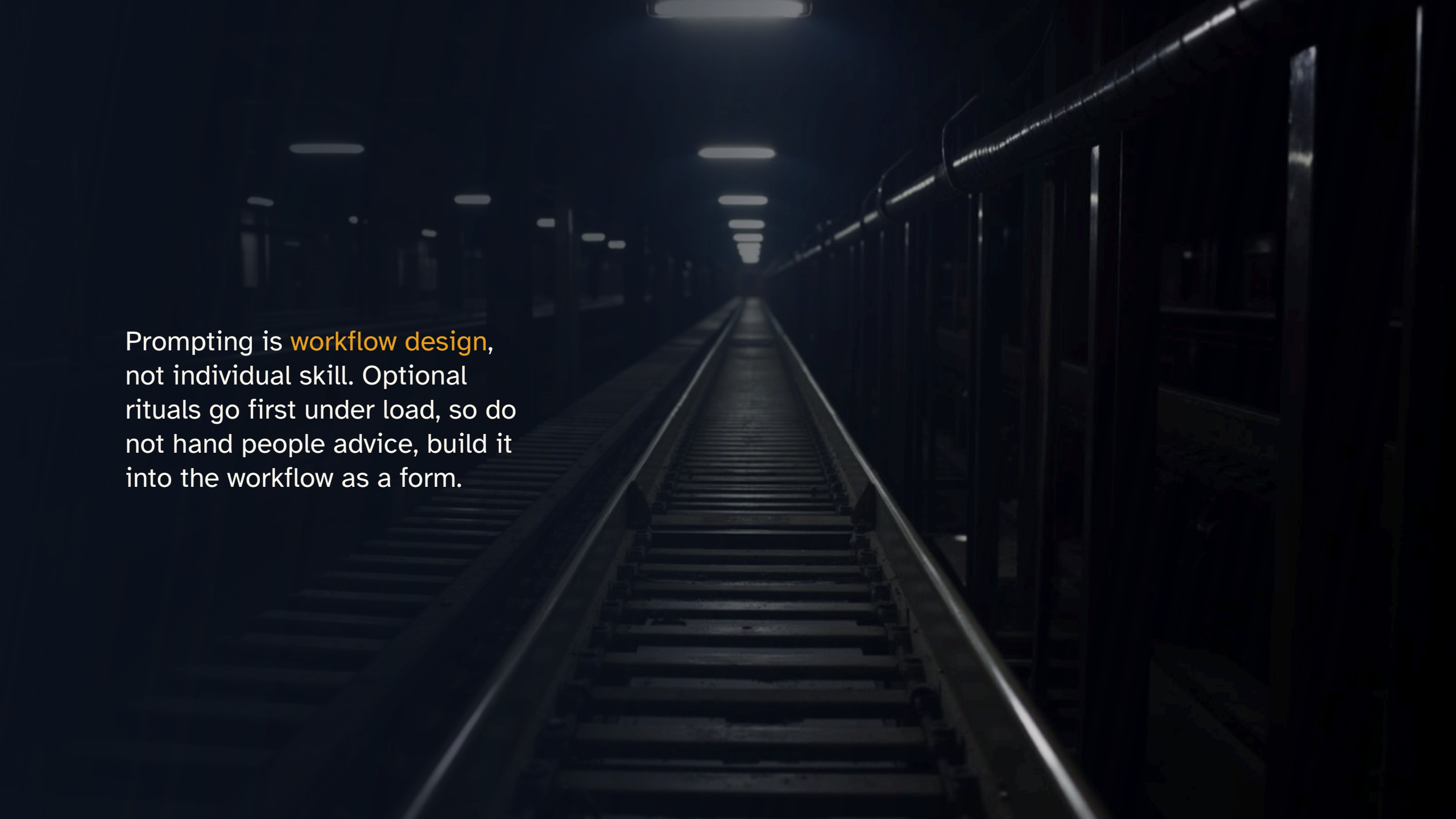
A person stands in the center of a dark, narrow hallway, looking out through a bright doorway at the end. The hallway is dimly lit, with light streaming in from the doorway, creating a strong silhouette of the person. The walls are dark, and the floor is also dark. The overall atmosphere is mysterious and contemplative.

WHAT TO WATCH FOR

The tool's framing matches yours and rarely diverges.

Challenging it feels like challenging your own competence.

Your review step confirms instead of interrogating.



Prompting is **workflow design**,
not individual skill. Optional
rituals go first under load, so do
not hand people advice, build it
into the workflow as a form.

THE GATE, FILLED IN

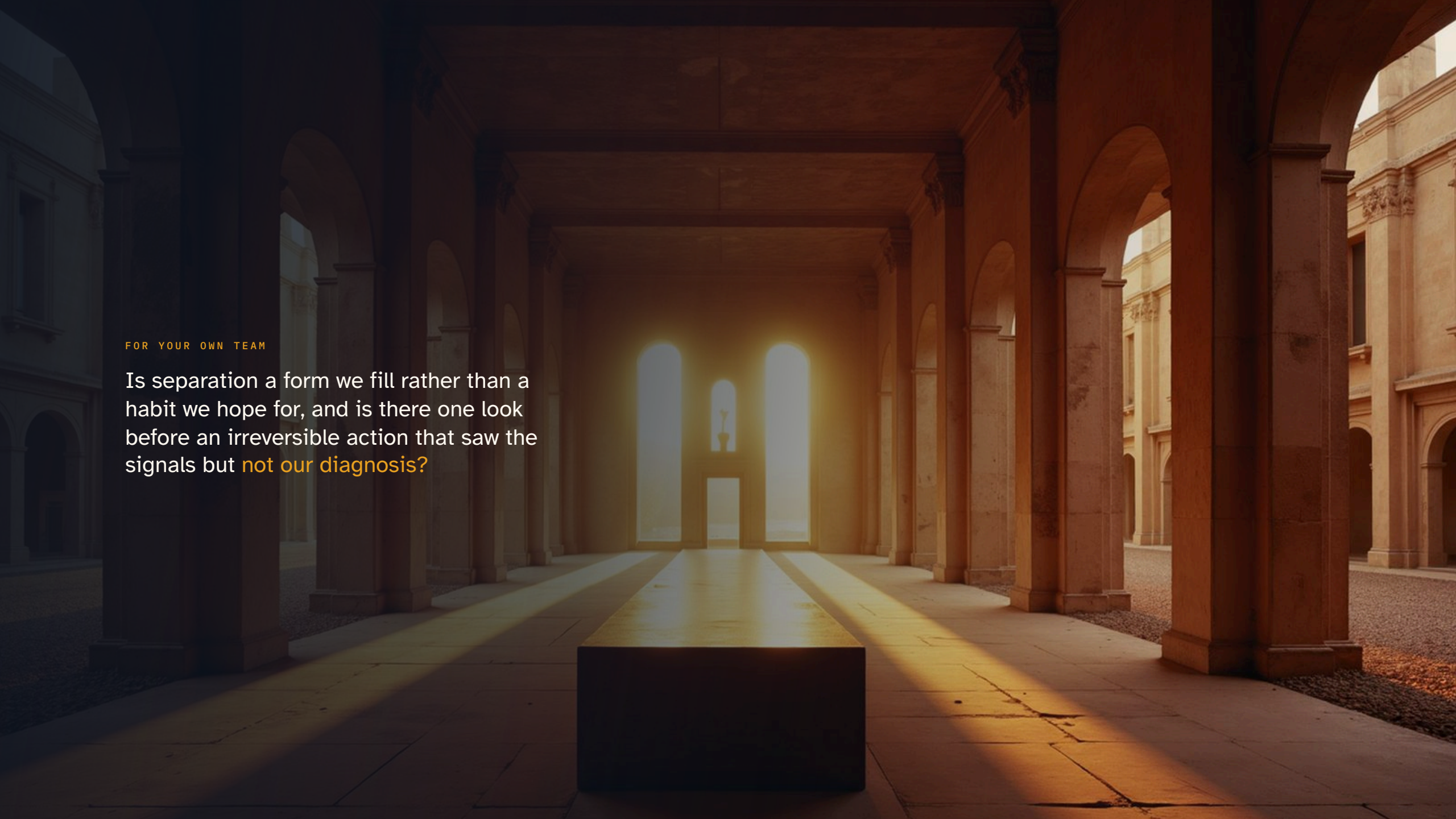
Current read	cache eviction
Strongest rival	downstream pool saturation under retries
Separating signal	eviction rate versus pool utilization
Expect / window	pool $\geq$ 95% for 5 min, eviction at baseline
Counts against	eviction flat while latency climbs
Action	cap retries, shed optional traffic
Safe across rivals	yes, reduces load either way
Roll back if	errors +2 pts, or no improvement in 10 min
Break glass	IC may act now, reason and time recorded, retro required

At 2am you are not proving a cause, you are choosing the **safest reversible action**. Choose the one that helps no matter what the real cause turns out to be, and settle in advance what would make you roll it back.



Almost nobody is truly unframed anymore. The realistic move is to hand the separate look the raw signals and **hold back your diagnosis.**





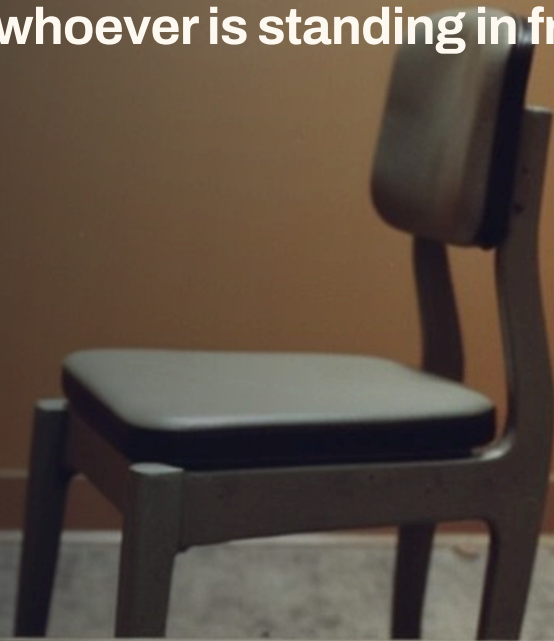
FOR YOUR OWN TEAM

Is separation a form we fill rather than a habit we hope for, and is there one look before an irreversible action that saw the signals but **not our diagnosis?**

The mirror is getting better at sounding like whoever is standing in front of it.

A failure we adjusted to over years, back in a form
our adjustments do not catch.

**The only question is whether anything in the
workflow can push back.**



BRIAN MORIARTY

Are You Talking to Me?



LINKEDIN

`/in/btmoriarty`



THE DECK

`hos1-research.github.io/manuscripts`